

# Cat Aggression Biting Guide — Action Checklist

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## RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES

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- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Schedule a veterinary visit if your cat's aggression is new, worsening, or has always been present, because pain and illness are the most commonly missed causes of biting.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Tell your veterinarian exactly when the biting happens, what triggers it, and which body part your cat targets, because specific details help vets identify underlying medical conditions.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Record video of aggressive episodes on your phone and bring it to the vet appointment, because cats often mask their worst behavior in clinical settings where they feel safer.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Treat any medical condition your vet finds, such as dental disease, arthritis, hyperthyroidism, or hypertension, because addressing the medical cause often resolves the aggression entirely.

## STOP PLAY ATTACKS

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- ☐ **Stop Play Attacks:** Use a wand toy to run through the prey sequence—hunt, catch, kill, eat—for 15 minutes before bed and before any human interaction that triggers attacks, because your cat needs to hunt something that is not you.
- ☐ **Stop Play Attacks:** Schedule play sessions in the evening and right before guests arrive or any situation that has previously triggered ambush attacks, because predictable play reduces predatory energy directed at people.
- ☐ **Stop Play Attacks:** Provide environmental enrichment like puzzle feeders, cat trees, and window perches so your cat has outlets for hunting behavior throughout the day, because a mentally stimulated cat is less likely to stalk your ankles.
- ☐ **Stop Play Attacks:** Recognize play aggression signs including attacks from hiding spots, back-leg bunny kicking, forward ears, and dilated pupils even in normal lighting, because these indicate your cat views you as prey rather than a threat.

## PREVENT PETTING BITES

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- ☐ **Prevent Petting Bites:** Watch for pre-bite warning signals including tail twitching, ears rotating sideways, shoulder skin rippling, dilated pupils, and sudden stillness during petting, because cats always give signals before they bite.

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  - ☐ **Prevent Petting Bites:** Stop petting immediately when you notice any warning signal like tail flicking or ear movement, because pushing through hoping your cat will adjust guarantees a bite is coming within seconds.

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  - ☐ **Prevent Petting Bites:** Let your cat walk away after petting sessions instead of pushing her off or holding her, because forcing continued contact after she's signaled enough violates her trust and escalates aggression.

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  - ☐ **Prevent Petting Bites:** Use a thick pillow or blanket as a buffer when you must move your cat away from you, because this protects your hands while preventing the direct contact that triggers defensive biting.
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